



TIMELINE OF DIGITAL MONEY

Since the technology for digital money was perfected, many cryptocurrencies have been released – although Bitcoin remains the largest. Now even central banks have begun investigating the potential of digital money.



Digital currency

Money that can be traded on exchanges directly between individuals using a computer or mobile device that is connected to the internet. Digital currency can also be bought and sold using conventional currencies. *See pp.222-225*

Crowdfunding

A way for individuals and groups to raise donations from donors over the internet, bypassing banks, charitable organizations, or government institutions. It is managed via an online intermediary who takes a percentage as a fee. *See pp.226-227*

Peer-to-peer lending

Loans arranged by online agencies who match would-be borrowers with lenders. Peer-to-peer lending is usually subject to fewer regulations than conventional lending. Borrowers are screened for risk, which is reflected in the interest rate they pay. *See pp.228-229*